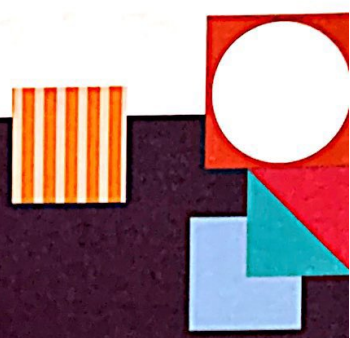




PAPER C

English

2019

**DO NOT OPEN THIS BOOKLET
UNTIL INSTRUCTED.**

40 QUESTIONS

TIME ALLOWED: 50 MINUTES

Read the instructions on the **ANSWER SHEET** and fill in your **NAME, SCHOOL** and **OTHER INFORMATION**.

Use a pencil. Do **NOT** use a coloured pencil or a pen.

Rub out any mistakes completely.

You **MUST** record your answers on the **ANSWER SHEET**.

Mark only **ONE** answer for each question.

Your score will be the number of correct answers.

Marks are **NOT** deducted for incorrect answers.

There are **40 MULTIPLE-CHOICE QUESTIONS** (1–40).

Use the information provided to choose the **BEST** answer from the four possible options.

On your **ANSWER SHEET** fill in the oval that matches your answer.

Questions may sometimes be placed next to each other.

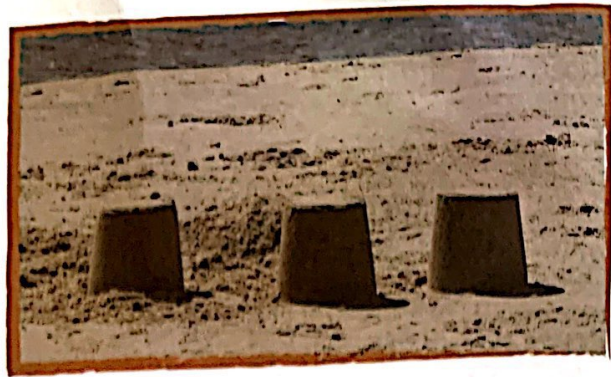
Make sure you read **ACROSS** the page and answer the questions in the correct order.

You are **NOT** allowed to use a dictionary or an electronic translator.

SAND AND CASTLES

How I build a sandcastle

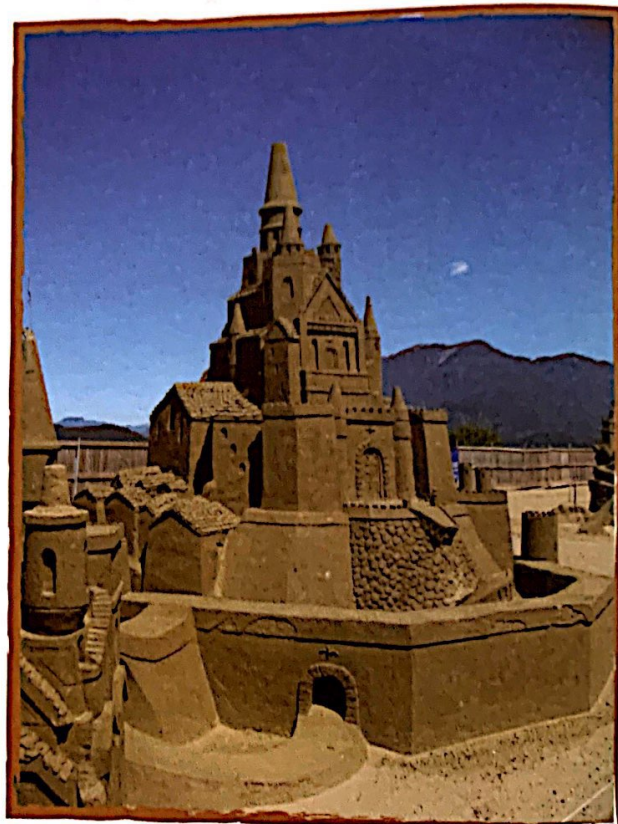
It all seems quite straightforward really: put some wet sand in a bucket, tip the bucket over, give it a good whack with your hand or your little shovel if you want to be technical, and hey-presto! You have a sandcastle. Mine's the one just over there on the right, in case you're wondering!



My sandcastle

How do other people build a sandcastle?

Clearly, some people take their sandcastle construction a little more seriously. These people know a thing or two about sand! Sand grains can vary in size but, scientifically speaking, to be called sand the particles must be between 0.0625 mm and 2 mm in diameter. Particles which are larger than 2 mm in diameter are referred to as pebbles or small rocks, not sand. Professional sand carvers use sand that has square-shaped grains. When this type of sand is very damp, it can be moulded, cut and shaped into amazing constructions. For the less ambitious who don't take a microscope to the beach to examine particle shape and size, the trick is to make sure your sand is very wet—it will hold its shape better, according to the experts.



Someone else's sandcastle

A short history of sand

Sand forms when rocks, coral and shells are broken down into minute pieces, a result of the action of wind and water. These tiny grains of rock may be blown around by wind or carried down rivers into the ocean.

Studying individual grains of sand under a microscope can reveal a lot about their history and composition. For example, quartz sand that has been weathered (broken down) from granite has a very angular shape, while sand that has travelled long distances has a more rounded shape. The sand found at your local beach is probably a rounded shape after thousands of years tumbling around in the ocean. These are important considerations for serious sandcastle construction: larger sand grains will not stick together easily, while rounded sand grains do not stick together as well as more angular, square-shaped grains.

1. What does the word 'whack' show?
- (A) the sound of the hand or shovel hitting the bucket
 - (B) how angry the writer is when she builds sandcastles
 - (C) when to knock the sand out of the bucket
 - (D) what the writer says when she builds sandcastles
2. The writer uses the words 'hey-prestol' in the first paragraph to suggest
- (A) that she is a beginner at building sandcastles.
 - (B) how quick and easy it is for her to make a sandcastle.
 - (C) that making a sandcastle is a matter of luck.
 - (D) why she feels excited about building sandcastles.
3. What is the writer's attitude towards the skills of professional sandcastle builders?
- (A) She is jealous of their skills.
 - (B) She is impressed by their skills.
 - (C) She is enchanted by their skills.
 - (D) She is annoyed by their skills.
4. The word 'ambitious', as it is used in the text, means
- (A) able.
 - (B) eager.
 - (C) energetic.
 - (D) scientific.
5. What advice is given to people who would like to build a sandcastle but do not know a lot about sand?
- (A) Examine sand grains with a microscope.
 - (B) Choose wind-blown sand.
 - (C) Mould the sand carefully.
 - (D) Use very damp sand.
6. Which is the best material to use for making a sandcastle?
- (A) 4 mm pieces of granite with square-shaped grains
 - (B) 1.5 mm quartz grains with angular shapes
 - (C) 2 mm rounded pieces of shell or coral
 - (D) 3 mm wet grains of quartz

PEARL VERSES THE WORLD

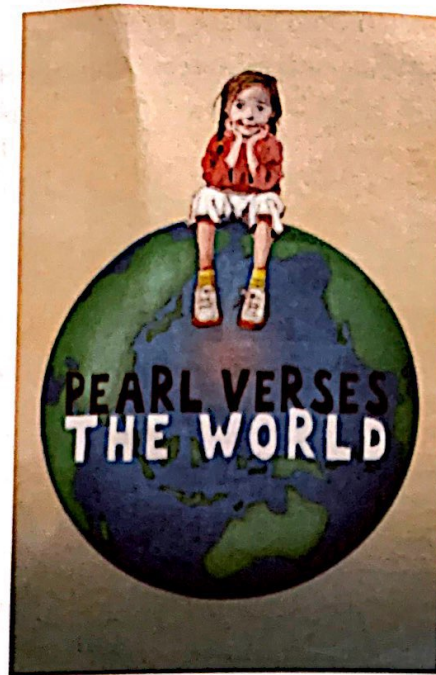
*Your Pearl, Miss Bruff says
Is a wonderful writer.
She writes the best stories
And essays.
I love to read her work.
But she doesn't like poetry.*

*Ha!
I say inside my head.
What do you know, Miss Bruff?
I love writing poetry.
You just don't like my style.
You want rhyme
And rhythm
And happy endings
But my poems
Don't rhyme
Can't rhyme
Shouldn't rhyme.
Rhyme
Does not a poem make.*

*Mum murmurs a sound
Of surprise.*

*I did not know
My Pearl was a writer.
She doesn't show me her stories.
She didn't show her granny, either.*

*Wrong, Mum!
Granny DID know.
On quiet afternoons
When you were working
And Granny and I were home alone
I would tell her my stories
And she would tell me hers.*



*One day Granny read me
A poem
About a man stealing a plum.
Granny, I remember saying,
Why are there no rhymes
In that poem?
Granny laughed.
Why, Pearl, didn't you know
A poem does not have to rhyme?
It does not have to be written
In a certain way
At a certain time.
No.
A poem comes
When it is needed
And writes itself
In the way it needs
To get its point across.*

Sally Murphy

7. Which literary device is used in the title?
- (A) simile
 - (B) pun
 - (C) paradox
 - (D) rhyme
8. Miss Bruff assumed that Pearl disliked poetry because
- (A) Pearl wrote essays when she should have been writing poetry.
 - (B) Pearl misbehaved in class during poetry writing time.
 - (C) Pearl wrote poetry in a form that Miss Bruff did not appreciate.
 - (D) Pearl did not know how to write poems that rhyme.
9. In the third stanza, the word 'murmurs' means that Pearl's mother
- (A) keeps quiet about what she is really thinking.
 - (B) says the word 'surprise' in a soft voice.
 - (C) whispers something to Miss Bruff.
 - (D) makes a sound that can barely be heard.
10. 'Why, Pearl, didn't you know / A poem does not have to rhyme?'
- Why did Granny laugh before she said this?
- (A) She was genuinely surprised that Pearl thought poems needed to rhyme.
 - (B) She thought that Pearl was unusual because she did not know much about poetry.
 - (C) She believed Pearl was making a joke about the poem she had just read.
 - (D) She realised that Pearl was pretending not to know about writing poetry.
11. Some parts of the text are written in *italics* because
- (A) they express the characters' feelings.
 - (B) they are words spoken aloud by the characters.
 - (C) they show the conflict between Pearl and other characters.
 - (D) they show what happened in the past.
12. Pearl gained the confidence to write her own style of poetry after
- (A) her mother expressed surprise at the quality of her writing.
 - (B) she heard that Miss Bruff liked her stories.
 - (C) Granny explained that there are many ways to write poetry.
 - (D) she worked out how to improve her rhymes.

SWEET REVENGE AT THE ROYAL ZOO

This is an extract from the novel The Hair-Raising Adventures of Juniper Jasper by Dudsy O'Sullivan. Sister Tarantula is the nickname Juniper and Sherby have given to the nun who teaches them at St Grizelda's School.

Both Juniper and Sherby would normally have sat as far away as possible from the Tarantula. For instance, if the nun sat at the front of the bus, they would have been quite happy sitting right at the back of, say, Zimbabwe! But today, they needed to be close to the action. Their eyes were riveted to Sister Tarantula's wooden leg, and the trails of sawdust that kept dribbling out of her shoe. Juniper was overjoyed that her wooden leg theory had been proven at last. The question now was how long it would take to exact her revenge. The termites might suddenly lose their appetite—gnawing away at the Tarantula might give them shocking indigestion! You never could tell with termites. Both she and Sherby would keep a close eye on the sawdust situation—it could take some time. In the meantime, Juniper was determined to enjoy her day at the zoo.



They finally arrived, and Sister Tarantula stamped her foot and shoved the children into two straight lines. Blowing a shrill whistle, she marched at the head of this brigade. She had separated Sherby and Juniper to stop them chattering and giggling. These two little troublemakers, decided Sister Tarantula, had an irritating way of enjoying themselves far too much. She would not tolerate such gaiety in her class—it must be stamped out. But it would take much more than a lot of foot-stamping and whistle-blowing to stop Juniper from enjoying herself. She felt like browsing and wandering amongst the different animals on display.

Sister Tarantula, however, insisted on planning the day down to the last detail. She marched everyone towards the spider and reptile enclosure. Juniper didn't fancy that idea at all, and as the troop turned a corner, she ducked behind a clump of ferns.

Turning around, she came face to face with an orang-utan who was peering at her through the bars of his cage.

13. Juniper and Sherby changed their usual seating arrangement because
- (A) they wanted a better view of the scenery.
 - (B) Sister Tarantula told them to sit close to her.
 - (C) they wanted to be first off the bus at the zoo.
 - (D) they wanted to watch Sister Tarantula's wooden leg.
14. Juniper's plan to prove her 'wooden leg theory' involved
- (A) putting termites in Sister Tarantula's shoe.
 - (B) filling Sister Tarantula's shoes with sawdust.
 - (C) getting Sherby to follow Sister Tarantula around.
 - (D) making Sister Tarantula stamp her foot a lot.
15. Which word is **NOT** used as a verb in the first paragraph?
- (A) 'riveted'
 - (B) 'proven'
 - (C) 'exact'
 - (D) 'shocking'
16. What is 'the sawdust situation'?
- (A) a specific place
 - (B) a particular time
 - (C) an uncomfortable feeling
 - (D) an ongoing event
17. The writer uses the words 'brigade' and 'troop' to reinforce the idea that the students are
- (A) willing to do anything to please their teacher.
 - (B) being strictly controlled by their teacher.
 - (C) about to undertake special duties at the zoo.
 - (D) going on a tour with a zookeeper.
18. In order for readers to understand the students' feelings about Sister Tarantula, they must know
- (A) how she got her wooden leg.
 - (B) that Zimbabwe is the name of a country.
 - (C) that tarantulas are greatly disliked.
 - (D) how long she has been their teacher.

Creepy Underwater Crawlies

Going underwater is about to get creepier. Lurking in the shallow waters of your favourite beach and inhabiting the depths of the coldest oceans are creeping, crawling sea spiders. Ranging in size from one millimetre to more than 90 centimetres, these creatures look like the stars of a science fiction horror movie.

With their small bodies and really long legs, it is easy to have nightmares about sea spiders larger than your head crawling all over you, but it gets creepier. Sea spiders are equipped with a proboscis (a long appendage on their head) for feeding on their prey. These carnivorous crawlies insert their proboscis into the soft body of an invertebrate and then suck out the juicy goodness. Surprisingly, the poor prey often survives this gruesome attack. Although this type of feeding sounds gross, invertebrates such as sea sponges and sea anemones are generally larger than the spider, and so will survive being fed on ... most of the time.



A sea spider in the McMurdo Sound in Antarctica

There are more than 1300 known species of sea spiders. They can have four, five or six pairs of legs. Their bodies are so thin that they do not need a respiratory system; instead, their body surface is large enough to allow them to breathe by diffusion, which means oxygen is absorbed through their skin. In fact, their bodies are so small that their organs spread out to their legs. Many sea spiders that live deep in the ocean are blind.

Sea spiders are such unusual creatures that scientists are still a little puzzled about how to classify them. Sea spiders are not considered true spiders or arachnids. They have a segmented exoskeleton, which makes them arthropods just like insects, crabs and spiders. But other strange features such as their proboscis make it difficult to decide exactly what type of arthropod they are.

Marine zoologist Dr Claudia Arango of the Australian Museum finds sea spiders fascinating, especially the ones that live in Antarctica. 'They are more diverse, more abundant, bigger and weirder than sea spiders in other parts of the world: that makes them a very attractive fauna,' says Dr Arango.

Next time you go to the beach, head over to the rocks and investigate; you may just find a little sea spider camouflaged in the shallow water. But don't worry, the really big ones only live in the depths of the Antarctic Ocean.

19. Sea spiders feed on sea anemones because
- (A) they have soft bodies.
 - (B) they have thin bodies.
 - (C) they are larger than their predators.
 - (D) they are able to survive after being attacked.
20. What is the meaning of the word 'gruesome'?
- (A) frequent
 - (B) horrifying
 - (C) unexpected
 - (D) sudden
21. Sea spiders breathe by diffusion. This allows them to
- (A) store oxygen in their legs.
 - (B) take in oxygen through their skin.
 - (C) control their respiratory system.
 - (D) suck oxygen from their prey.
22. 'Many sea spiders that live deep in the ocean are blind.'
- Which word or words could be placed at the beginning of this sentence in the third paragraph?
- (A) Yet
 - (B) So
 - (C) As a result
 - (D) In addition
23. Why are sea spiders described in the text as 'unusual creatures'?
- (A) They are arachnids and they breathe by diffusion.
 - (B) They are invertebrates and they are also carnivores.
 - (C) They are arthropods and they have a proboscis.
 - (D) They can live in both deep and shallow water.
24. What is the main purpose of the final paragraph?
- (A) to scare readers into staying away from sea spiders
 - (B) to urge readers to investigate the sea spiders of the Antarctic Ocean
 - (C) to reassure readers that sea spiders are unlikely to be a threat to them
 - (D) to warn readers against taking unnecessary risks with sea spiders
25. What is the text underneath the photograph called?
- (A) caption
 - (B) label
 - (C) subheading
 - (D) glossary
26. What does the writer assume about her readers?
- (A) They are scared of spiders.
 - (B) They know what a sea spider looks like.
 - (C) They understand what a proboscis is.
 - (D) They have studied the Antarctic Ocean.

Living bridges

It's relatively easy to grow a lawn or a garden, but what about growing a bridge?

In the small town of Cherrapunji, in the north-eastern Indian state of Meghalaya, people have been using the roots of the *Ficus elastica* (also known as the Indian rubber tree) to create strong, living bridges for more than 500 years. It is a simple enough process—if you know what you are doing! Adventitious roots (supporting roots) growing from the trunks of rubber trees are trained to grow through the centres of hollow tree trunks that have been laid across a river or ravine. In time, the roots grow across any gaps to take root on the opposite bank. Do this with a few roots for the floor, a few more for the sides and—voilà!—you've got a living bridge!



Because these bridges are made from the roots of living trees, they don't decay over time in the same way that wooden bridges often do. In fact, many living bridges actually grow stronger as the roots that make up their structure thicken over time. Some of these root bridges reach nearly 30 metres in length and can support up to 50 people at once.

These remarkable living bridges have existed in this seldom-visited corner of India for a long time, although they have only recently been publicised in the world beyond. Today the villagers who build and maintain these bridges do so with an eye to conservation and the knowledge that their astonishing creations are unique. 'Going green' might be a popular idea for builders looking to reduce their environmental impact, but few of them could ever hope to match the ingenious people of Cherrapunji!

27. In the first sentence, the writer says 'but what about growing a bridge?' because
- (A) he thinks that bridges are useful garden features.
 - (B) he wants to challenge readers to grow bridges.
 - (C) he wants to interest readers in the idea of growing a bridge.
 - (D) he is undecided if it is possible to grow a bridge.

28. 'It is a simple enough process—if you know what you are doing!'

The exclamation mark in this sentence indicates that

- (A) the writer is astonished by the idea.
- (B) the writer is doubtful about the idea.
- (C) the idea needs additional emphasis.
- (D) the idea opposes common sense.

29. According to the text, which two features make the *Ficus elastica* tree suitable for building living bridges?

	Feature one	Feature two
(A)	rubbery bark	flexible roots
(B)	grows near river banks	adventitious roots
(C)	hollow trunk	ability to grow rapidly
(D)	size of the leaves	shape of the trunk

30. In the first sentence of the third paragraph, which word could replace 'Because' and retain the same meaning?

- (A) Since
- (B) When
- (C) Although
- (D) Whereas

31. What is the main idea of the third paragraph?

- (A) the types of roots that form the living bridges
- (B) why living bridges are easier to build than wooden ones
- (C) how modern bridges can be strengthened using tree roots
- (D) the benefits of a living bridge compared with a wooden one

32. The phrase 'with an eye to' means

- (A) with a preference for.
- (B) promoting the idea of.
- (C) in order to establish.
- (D) with the intention of.

CHILD'S PLAY

The year is 1150 BCE. The location is a meadow not far from Stonehenge in Britain.

'Are we all present?' boomed Drystan, the 'leader' of our little band, while adjusting his lately acquired deerskin cloak which he wore as his symbol of leadership.

Eleven voices murmured agreement and one asked, 'Is this a birthday party?'

'No laughter in the stone circle,' Drystan tried to boom again while undoing the bone toggle of his cloak which was threatening to constrict his breathing.

'The purpose of our meeting today is to discuss design ideas for a small shelter so we can have our meetings in all weather conditions,' Drystan informed us.

'We could use a few animal skins stretched over a timber frame,' I suggested.

'That's a dumb idea, Anyou,' Drystan intoned.

Clearly, praise and encouragement were aspects of leadership that Drystan needed to develop further.

'We will build our shelter using stone,' stated Drystan.

'Yes, Drystan. Of course, Drystan,' we all chimed.

All day we collected stones, piling, wedging and balancing them until we had a shelter that looked like it had been designed by a landslide. Still, it seemed to please Drystan and that's all that mattered really. The last job of the day involved rolling an extra large log near the entrance to the shelter. Drystan would use this as his podium when he was directing his horde of followers.

Dutifully we pushed the designated log in the approximate direction of the shelter. The remaining events are listed in our (secret) meeting records as follows:

1. After a bit of a push, the log gathered speed as a result of a slight incline.
2. The log took off on its own accord and proceeded (quickly) in a northerly direction towards Stonehenge.
3. The log came to rest against a stone pillar at the entrance and the pillar was dislodged.
4. Large stones fell like dominoes around the circle that was Stonehenge.
5. In unspoken agreement we all left the scene immediately. Drystan had a head start on all of us.

A few months later I overheard a conversation among the village elders as to the cause of the Stonehenge catastrophe. One voice was louder than the rest: 'An unusual alignment of stars in combination with a rainbow and an easterly wind!' I recognised it as the voice of Drystan's father. The other elders nodded their agreement. Drystan must have inherited his father's leadership skills, I concluded, because they both have strong voices.



33. What do the words 'lately acquired' suggest about Drystan's cloak?
- (A) He had recently got the cloak.
 - (B) Nobody else had a similar cloak.
 - (C) He had to work hard to earn the cloak.
 - (D) Only he was allowed to wear the cloak.
34. When Anyou described the shelter as looking like it had been 'designed by a landslide', he meant that it was
- (A) ruined.
 - (B) messy.
 - (C) rocky.
 - (D) dangerous.
35. According to Anyou, why was Drystan the leader?
- (A) He had the loudest voice.
 - (B) He had the cleverest ideas.
 - (C) He had a father whom the children feared.
 - (D) He had been given a symbol of leadership.
36. The writer changes from a narrative style to a list in order to
- (A) imitate the language spoken by the village elders.
 - (B) provide an alternative opinion about what happened.
 - (C) make the recount of the events that occurred seem very objective.
 - (D) illustrate the writer's different opinion about the children after what happened.
37. Which point in the meeting notes supports the idea that the notes were probably written without Drystan knowing about it?
- (A) Point 1 because it states that the children were not to blame.
 - (B) Point 2 because it suggests that the log had a mind of its own.
 - (C) Point 4 because it tries to make the toppling of the stones seem sudden.
 - (D) Point 5 because it suggests that the leader was the first to leave.
38. Which is **NOT** a possible reason for Drystan's father's explanation for the toppling of Stonehenge?
- (A) He wanted to protect his son from blame.
 - (B) He was trying to reassure the frightened villagers.
 - (C) He had predicted correctly that Stonehenge would fall.
 - (D) He wanted to impress the village elders with his knowledge.

Living fossils

Archaeologists regularly unearth fossils, which are the ancient remains of plants and animals slowly turned to rock over millions of years.

____ (39) ____ there is another kind of 'fossil' to be found on planet Earth: organisms still living, but unchanged for millions of years. These special plants and animals are known as 'living fossils', and are more common than you think. The humble horseshoe crab, for example, closely ____ (40) ____ a very primitive form of animal called a trilobite which died out around 250 million years ago.

39. Choose the option that best completes the text.

- (A) Whereas
- (B) Even if
- (C) Despite this
- (D) Yet

40. Choose the option that best completes the text.

- (A) resemble
- (B) resembling
- (C) resembled
- (D) resembles